5 COMMON INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Sample Interview Answers

Learn from examples. Practice your answers.
Get ready for your future career.

Introduction

Job interviews can be challenging, especially for university students who have little or no work experience. Preparing answers to common interview questions can help you feel more confident and communicate your strengths clearly.

In this section, you will learn **five common interview questions**, explore **sample answers**, and discover **useful expressions** you can use in your own interviews.

> **REMEMBER** Do not memorize every word. Use these examples as a guide and personalize your answers with your own experiences, skills, and goals.

The 5 questions in this guide

1. **Tell me about yourself.**
2. **What are your strengths?**
3. **What is your greatest weakness?**
4. **Why should we hire you?**
5. **Where do you see yourself in five years?**

1 Tell me about yourself.

What does the interviewer want to know?

Your educational background, relevant skills, interests, and career goals.

Sample Answer

> “Hello, my name is Anna. I am a third-year English major at HUFLIT. I am interested in communication and teaching. During my studies, I have developed my teamwork, presentation, and problem-solving skills through group projects and class activities. I am a responsible and willing-to-learn person. I hope to gain practical experience and improve my professional skills through this opportunity.”

How is the answer structured?

1. **Introduction:** State your name and current studies.
2. **Skills and experience:** Mention relevant skills gained through university activities.
3. **Career goal:** Explain what you hope to gain from the position.

Useful expressions

- *“I am currently a student at …”*
- *“I have developed my … skills through …”*
- *“I am interested in …”*
- *“I hope to gain practical experience in …”*

TIP Keep your introduction relevant to the job. You do not need to share your entire personal history.

2 What are your strengths?

What does the interviewer want to know?

Whether your personal qualities and skills match the requirements of the position.

Sample Answer

> “One of my main strengths is that I am a quick learner. When I work on a new task, I try to understand the instructions carefully and learn from feedback. For example, during a group project at university, I had to use a new presentation tool. I learned how to use it and helped my team prepare our presentation. I believe this strength will help me adapt to a new working environment.”

How is the answer structured?

Strength → **Example** → **Job relevance**

1. **Strength:** Identify one or two qualities relevant to the job.
2. **Example:** Describe a real situation that demonstrates your strength.
3. **Job relevance:** Explain how the strength can help you perform the role.

Useful expressions

- *“One of my main strengths is …”*
- *“I am good at …”*
- *“For example, during a university project, I …”*
- *“I believe this skill will help me …”*

TIP Choose a strength that matches the job description. Whenever possible, support it with a specific example rather than simply saying, “I am hardworking.”

3 What is your greatest weakness?

What does the interviewer want to know?

Whether you understand your areas for improvement and are willing to learn.

Sample Answer

> “One area I am working on is my public speaking. Sometimes, I feel nervous when speaking in front of a large audience. To improve, I have started volunteering to present in class and practicing before each presentation. I have become more confident over time, and I will continue working on this skill.”

How is the answer structured?

Weakness → **Action** → **Improvement**

1. **Weakness:** Mention a genuine area you want to improve.
2. **Action:** Explain what you are doing to improve it.
3. **Improvement:** Describe your progress or future plan.

Useful expressions

- *“One area I am working on is …”*
- *“Sometimes, I find it difficult to …”*
- *“To improve, I have started …”*
- *“I have made progress by …”*
- *“I will continue working on this skill.”*

TIP Be honest but professional. Avoid weaknesses that directly prevent you from doing the essential tasks of the job, and always explain how you are improving.

4 Why should we hire you?

What does the interviewer want to know?

What you can contribute to the company and why you are a suitable candidate.

Sample Answer

> “I believe I would be a good fit for this position because I am responsible, adaptable, and eager to learn. Although I do not have much professional experience yet, I have developed communication and teamwork skills through university projects. I am also willing to learn from my colleagues and take on new challenges. If given this opportunity, I will do my best to contribute to the team and grow with the company.”

How is the answer structured?

Relevant qualities → **Evidence** → **Contribution**

1. **Relevant qualities:** Identify skills or qualities that match the position.
2. **Evidence:** Connect those qualities to your studies, projects, volunteering, or part-time work.
3. **Contribution:** Explain how you will contribute to the team.

Useful expressions

- *“I believe I would be a good fit for this position because …”*
- *“Although I do not have much professional experience yet, …”*
- *“I have developed my … skills through …”*
- *“I am willing to learn and take on new challenges.”*
- *“I hope to contribute to …”*

TIP As a student, you can use examples from class projects, clubs, volunteering, internships, and part-time jobs. You do not need years of work experience to demonstrate your potential.

5 Where do you see yourself in five years?

What does the interviewer want to know?

Your career goals, motivation, and willingness to grow professionally.

Sample Answer

> “In five years, I hope to become a skilled professional in my chosen field. First, I want to gain practical experience, improve my communication skills, and learn from experienced colleagues. As I gain more knowledge, I hope to take on greater responsibilities and contribute to important projects. I understand that career growth takes time, so I am ready to learn and work hard to achieve my goals.”

How is the answer structured?

Career goal → **Development plan** → **Future contribution**

1. **Career goal:** Describe the professional you hope to become.
2. **Development plan:** Explain the skills and experience you want to gain.
3. **Future contribution:** Describe how you hope to contribute as you grow.

Useful expressions

- *“In five years, I hope to …”*
- *“My short-term goal is to …”*
- *“I would like to gain experience in …”*
- *“I hope to develop my … skills.”*
- *“As I gain more experience, I would like to …”*

TIP You do not need to predict your exact job title in five years. Focus on realistic goals, continuous learning, and professional development.

★ Quick Practice: Build Your Own Answer

Now it is your turn! Use the sentence starters below to prepare your own responses. Try to include **personal examples** instead of copying the sample answers word for word.

1 Tell me about yourself.

- **I am currently a student at …**
- **I have developed my … skills through …**

2 What are your strengths?

- **One of my main strengths is …**
- **For example, during a university project, I …**

3 What is your greatest weakness?

- **One area I am working on is …**
- **To improve, I have started …**

4 Why should we hire you?

- **I believe I would be a good fit for this position because …**
- **I hope to contribute to …**

5 Where do you see yourself in five years?

- **In five years, I hope to …**
- **I would like to gain experience in …**

✓ Final Tips for Interview Success

1. **Be yourself**
   Adapt sample answers to your real experiences.

2. **Be specific**
   Give examples that show your skills and qualities.

3. **Keep it concise**
   Aim for around 30–60 seconds for most answers.

4. **Practice aloud**
   Focus on clear pronunciation, natural pacing, and confident delivery.

5. **Stay positive**
   Show that you are willing to learn and improve.